Report card comments for behavior and work habits

Pick two or three habits. For each, use a **strength** or **on track** line, then at most one **next step** and one thing to try **at home**. Swap [Name] and "their" for the student's name and pronoun. Lines marked with grades suit those grades only.

Work habits

Listening and following directions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] listens carefully and follows directions the first time. K–2, 3–5
- **STRENGTH** [Name] listens closely to instructions and gets started straight away.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] follows multi-step instructions accurately and checks the task sheet before asking. 6–8
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows most directions and is learning to listen to the whole instruction before starting.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] listens well in small groups and is learning to do the same in whole-class lessons.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is listening to the whole instruction before starting a task, which we're practicing by repeating instructions back to a partner. K–2, 3–5
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is listening to the whole instruction before starting a task, which we're practicing by checking the steps on the board before starting. 6–8
- **AT HOME** At home, you could give [Name] two-step jobs at home, such as "shoes away, then wash your hands", and praise finishing both. K–2
- **AT HOME** At home, you could give [Name] two- or three-step jobs at home and praise finishing all of them. 3–5
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to talk you through the steps of a homework task before starting. 6–8

Staying on task

- **STRENGTH** [Name] stays focused on their work and uses class time well.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] settles to work quickly and keeps going until the task is finished.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses most class time well and is learning to get back to work after a distraction.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] settles to work quickly and is building the stamina to keep going for longer.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is staying focused for the whole of independent work time, which we're practicing with short goals and a quick check-in partway through.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could set a timer for short bursts of homework or reading, with a quick break in between.

Working independently

- **STRENGTH** [Name] works independently and tries things on their own before asking for help.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] tackles new tasks on their own with confidence.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] works independently on familiar tasks and is learning to try new ones before asking for help.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is becoming more independent and is learning to use the help available in the classroom.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is trying a task on their own first, then asking for help with a specific question, which we're practicing with a short list of things to try when stuck.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could before helping with homework, ask [Name] "what have you tried so far?".

Organization

- **STRENGTH** [Name] keeps their things tidy and knows where everything belongs. K–2
- **STRENGTH** [Name] gets ready for each activity quickly and keeps their things tidy. K–2
- **STRENGTH** [Name] keeps their materials organized and plans their time well. 3–5
- **STRENGTH** [Name] keeps track of what is due and has everything ready for each lesson. 3–5
- **STRENGTH** [Name] plans longer tasks carefully and keeps track of deadlines. 6–8
- **STRENGTH** [Name] keeps their materials organized and manages their time well across subjects. 6–8
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to keep their things tidy and ready for the next activity. K–2
- **ON TRACK** [Name] gets ready for most activities quickly and is learning to put things back where they belong. K–2
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to keep their materials organized and to plan their time. 3–5
- **ON TRACK** [Name] keeps track of most tasks and is learning to plan longer pieces of work. 3–5
- **ON TRACK** [Name] keeps track of most deadlines and is learning to plan longer projects in stages. 6–8
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to use a planner to manage work across subjects. 6–8
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is keeping their things tidy and ready for the next activity, which we're practicing with picture checklists. K–2
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is keeping their desk and folders organized, which we're practicing with a quick tidy-up routine at the end of each day. 3–5
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using a planner to keep track of homework and deadlines, which we're practicing with a weekly planner check. 6–8
- **AT HOME** At home, you could let [Name] pack their own school bag the night before, with a picture checklist. K–2
- **AT HOME** At home, you could help [Name] pack their bag the night before, using a short checklist. 3–5
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at [Name]'s planner together once a week and talk about what's coming up. 6–8

Completing work on time Grades 3–5 and 6–8

- **STRENGTH** [Name] completes and hands in work on time, including homework.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] takes responsibility for their work and meets deadlines.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] hands in most work on time and is learning to keep track of deadlines.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] completes class work and is building a routine for homework.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is handing in homework and assignments on time, which we're practicing with a homework checklist. 3–5
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is handing in homework and assignments on time, which we're practicing with reminders on the class page and a weekly planner check. 6–8
- **AT HOME** At home, you could agree a regular time and place for homework, and check it's packed the night before.

Effort and perseverance

- **STRENGTH** [Name] keeps trying when work is hard and learns from mistakes.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] puts real effort into every task and sees challenging work through.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] puts good effort into most tasks and is learning to keep going when work is hard.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building resilience and is learning to see mistakes as part of learning.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is sticking with a task when it gets hard, using a strategy before asking for help, which we're practicing with a list of "what to try when I'm stuck" ideas.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could praise the effort, not just the result: "you kept going even when it was tricky".

Taking part in lessons

- **STRENGTH** [Name] takes an active part in lessons and shares thoughtful ideas.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks great questions and is keen to try new things.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] joins in discussions and is growing in confidence when sharing ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] takes part in lessons and is starting to share ideas with the whole class.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is sharing their ideas in class discussions, which we're practicing with talk partners first, then the whole class.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to teach you one thing from school each week.

Taking care with work

- **STRENGTH** [Name] takes pride in their work and checks it carefully.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] presents their work carefully and fixes their own mistakes.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] takes care with most work and is learning to check it before handing it in.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to slow down and check their work on longer tasks.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is checking their work before handing it in, which we're practicing with a short checklist for each task.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to show you a favorite piece of work and talk about how it was made.

Behavior and getting on with others

Kindness and respect

- **STRENGTH** [Name] is kind and respectful to everyone in the class.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] notices when others need help and offers it without being asked.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is friendly with classmates and is learning to include others in games. K–2
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses kind words most of the time and is learning to use them when frustrated too. K–2
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is friendly with classmates and is learning to include others in games and group work. 3–5
- **ON TRACK** [Name] speaks respectfully to others and is learning to keep it up when frustrated. 3–5
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is respectful to classmates and is learning to include others in group work. 6–8
- **ON TRACK** [Name] speaks respectfully to others and is learning to keep a calm tone when frustrated. 6–8
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using kind words and including others, which we're practicing through our class agreements and regular class meetings.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about a time someone was kind at school, and how it felt.

Working with others

- **STRENGTH** [Name] works well in a group, listening to others and sharing the work fairly.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] is a thoughtful partner who helps the group reach a decision.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] works well with a partner and is learning to share roles in a bigger group.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] contributes to group work and is learning to listen to ideas that differ from their own.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is taking turns and sharing the work fairly in a group, which we're practicing with clear group roles.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could play board games or cook together, taking turns and sharing the jobs.

Managing feelings

- **STRENGTH** [Name] manages their feelings well and calms down quickly after a setback.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] stays calm when things don't go to plan and talks through problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to name their feelings and to use a calming strategy when upset.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at calming down after a disappointment and talks to an adult when needed.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using a calming strategy, such as taking a few deep breaths, before reacting, which we're practicing with a calm-down corner and a feelings chart. K–2
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using a calming strategy, such as taking a few deep breaths, before reacting, which we're practicing with a calm-down space and a short reset routine. 3–5
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using a calming strategy, such as taking a few deep breaths, before reacting, which we're practicing with time to reset and a quiet chat afterwards. 6–8
- **AT HOME** At home, you could name feelings together ("you seem frustrated") and practice one calming strategy when things are calm.

Setting goals and asking for help Grades 3–5 and 6–8

- **STRENGTH** [Name] sets their own goals and checks their progress towards them.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] knows when to ask for help and asks clear questions.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to set a goal for their work and to check how it's going.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] asks for help when stuck and is learning to say exactly what the problem is.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is setting a small goal each week and checking progress, which we're practicing with weekly goal-setting in class.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] what their goal is this week and how it's going.

Following class routines

- **STRENGTH** [Name] follows class routines without reminders. K–2
- **STRENGTH** [Name] moves between activities calmly and quickly. K–2, 3–5
- **STRENGTH** [Name] follows class routines and expectations without reminders. 3–5
- **STRENGTH** [Name] follows school expectations and arrives at lessons ready to learn. 6–8
- **STRENGTH** [Name] manages their own behavior well across lessons and around school. 6–8
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows most routines and is learning to manage changes between activities. K–2
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows class expectations and needs fewer reminders each week. K–2, 3–5
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows most routines and is learning to settle quickly after breaks. 3–5
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows most expectations and is learning to arrive at lessons ready to start. 6–8
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows school expectations and needs fewer reminders each week. 6–8
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is moving between activities calmly, which we're practicing with a visual timetable and countdowns. K–2
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is following class expectations without reminders, which we're practicing with clear routines and quiet reminders. 3–5
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is arriving at lessons on time and ready to start, which we're practicing with a quick start-of-lesson routine. 6–8
- **AT HOME** At home, you could give a five-minute warning before changing activities, such as before bath time. K–2
- **AT HOME** At home, you could keep a regular morning and bedtime routine on school nights. 3–5, 6–8

Speaking at the right time

- **STRENGTH** [Name] waits their turn to speak and listens while others talk.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] contributes at the right moments and listens respectfully to others.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] puts their hand up to share ideas and is learning to wait while others are speaking.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to hold on to an idea until it's their turn to speak.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is waiting for their turn to speak in class discussions, which we're practicing with talk partners and a signal for when it's time to share.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could practice taking turns to talk at mealtimes, letting each person finish.

Sorting out disagreements

- **STRENGTH** [Name] sorts out disagreements calmly and fairly.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] listens to both sides and helps friends find a fair solution.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to sort out small disagreements with words and to ask an adult when needed.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] resolves most disagreements calmly and is learning to see the other person's point of view.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using words to sort out disagreements and asking an adult when needed, which we're practicing with a simple problem-solving routine.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could when siblings or friends disagree, ask [Name] "what could we do so it's fair for both?".

Helping and leading

- **STRENGTH** [Name] takes on classroom jobs willingly and sets a great example.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] shows leadership by helping others and suggesting ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] enjoys classroom jobs and is learning to take the lead in small groups.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] helps others when asked and is starting to offer without being asked.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is taking the lead in a small group, which we're practicing with classroom jobs and group roles.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could give [Name] a regular family job, such as setting the table, and thank them for it.

Phrases to avoid, rewritten

Instead of	Write
Maya is disruptive in class.	Maya sometimes calls out during discussions; we're practicing waiting for a turn to speak, with a signal for when it's time to share.
Leo is lazy and doesn't try.	Leo works best with short goals and a quick check-in partway through, and is learning to keep going for the whole of independent work time.
Amara is very talkative.	Amara enjoys sharing ideas and is learning to hold on to them until it's time to talk.
Ethan has a bad attitude.	Ethan is learning to keep a calm tone when frustrated, and a quiet chat after a reset is helping.
Sofia refuses to do her work.	Sofia is learning to start a task on her own, and a short list of things to try first is helping.
Noah can't sit still.	Noah works best with short tasks and movement breaks between them, and is building the stamina to stay focused for longer.
Grace always forgets her homework.	Grace is learning to keep track of homework; a weekly planner check is helping.
Omar is defiant and won't follow instructions.	Omar is learning to follow directions the first time, and repeating instructions back to a partner is helping.
Lily got three detentions this term.	Don't write it. Talk to the family about what happened; in the comment, say what Lily is learning to do instead.
Kai was moved to red on the behavior chart four times.	Kai is learning to manage changes between activities, and a five-minute warning before each one is helping.
Zoe is bossy in group work.	Zoe has lots of ideas for group work and is learning to listen to ideas that differ from her own.
Sam has anger issues and lashes out.	Sam is learning to use a calming strategy before reacting, and we practice it together when things are calm.
Isla's ADHD makes it hard for her to focus.	Isla settles to work quickly and is building the stamina to keep going for longer. (Talk about any extra support with the family in person.)
Jack is better behaved than most of the boys.	Jack follows class routines without reminders and sets a great example for others.
Priya is good as gold and a pleasure to have in class.	Priya is kind to everyone and notices when others need help.
Ben is a class clown.	Ben brings humor to our class and is learning to choose the right moments for it.
Ruby doesn't care about her work.	Ruby is learning to check her work before handing it in, with a short checklist for each task.
Maya should know how to line up by now.	Maya follows most routines and is learning to move between activities calmly.
Leo's behavior has been a problem since his parents split up.	Don't write it. Talk to the family privately; in the comment, describe what Leo is learning to do and what's helping.
Amara is off-task and shows work avoidance.	Amara is learning to get started on her work straight away, with a short goal for each task.
Ethan is immature for his age.	Ethan is learning to wait for his turn in group games, and taking turns at mealtimes at home would help.
Sofia never listens.	Sofia is learning to listen to the whole instruction before starting a task.

150 lines. Free from polytheseus.com/teacher-skills/guides/report-card-comments-for-behavior, where a free builder puts them together and checks the wording. Drafted with AI help: read every line against what you know of the student and your school's report rules before you use it.